to the right than those of Israelis inside the Green Line. In Ma'ale Adumim, a relatively non-ideological settlement (effectively a suburb of Jerusalem), the Likud party received 48 per cent of the vote in 2015, double its nationwide tally. As a whole, the right-wing bloc won 73 per cent there, up from 46 per cent in elections a decade earlier. The Zionist Camp received just 5 per cent—less than a third of its national average.

The extremist Yachad didn't clear the threshold to enter the Knesset. In a few small settlements, though, where even Bennett is now seen as too liberal, it won a majority. It turns out, in other words, that living illegally on occupied land, while ideologues insist on your religious claim to that land, is an incubator for extreme views.

Here the narrative comes full circle. Over the past few years, a growing number of liberal Jews in the diaspora have called for a settlement boycott. Except on the far left, though, they are quick to stress that they do not wish to boycott Israel as a whole. "A settlement boycott is not enough. It must be paired with an equally vigorous embrace of democratic Israel," Peter Beinart wrote in the *NewYork Times* in 2012.[3]

But as the Amona fiasco demonstrated, it is impossible to separate "democratic Israel" from the settlements, because the former supports the latter. The residents of Amona moved there illegally, without the state's permission, yet it was the state that ponied up nearly $1 million per family to relocate them. The number is striking, but it is a tiny fraction of the overall budget allocation for settlers. A 2010 analysis by an Israeli think tank found that the settler roads and highways alone were worth $1.7 billion (a number which has only grown since the study was conducted). The schools, synagogues and other public institutions cost another $500 million. The think tank, the Macro Center for Political Economics, reported in 2015 that settlers received about 1,013 shekels per capita for development; the residents of impoverished southern Israel received less than 400.[4] All of this money comes from "democratic Israel". Indeed, days after the Amona plan was agreed, Netanyahu announced hundreds of millions of shekels in budget cuts for education, health care, and grants to local authorities.

In one sense, then, Rosner is right. The settlers do not have "undue influence" over the Israeli government. Every Israeli government for the past fifty years, from center-left to far-right, has aided and abetted them. Nor does the ultra-Orthodox minority: prime ministers as far back as Ben-Gurion allowed them to maintain a grip on the religious identity of the state.